MODERN INDIA I · DAY 6 OF 6 · TEST ON 31 OCT 2026

Socio-Religious Reform Movements and Mixed Revision

When, where, why, by whom, key people, key events, for every movement · India map · mind map

About 30 questions today are on reform movements and about 20 are mixed revision from earlier days. Every movement below has the same card: **When, Where, Why, By whom, Key people, Key events, Result, Exam hook**. The numbered circle on a card is its place on the India map.

HOW TO USE THIS NOTE (ABOUT 60 MINUTES)

1. **5 min:** mind map and map (pages 2 to 4). Know where each family sits.
2. **35 min:** read the cards cluster by cluster. After each cluster, do its five-question recall box.
3. **10 min:** laws, master timeline and the revision section.
4. **5 min:** last-minute sheet. Then start the 50 questions.

1. The big picture

The Western-educated middle class met British rule, the printing press and Christian missionaries. This produced two kinds of response, plus a third that came from below.

Type	Idea	Examples
Reformist	Use reason and modern ideas to change Hindu and Muslim society from within	Brahmo Samaj, Prarthana Samaj, Aligarh movement, Young Bengal
Revivalist	Return to the pure original faith (Vedas, early Islam) and clean out later corruption	Arya Samaj, Deoband, Wahabi, Faraizi, Ramakrishna Mission (partly)

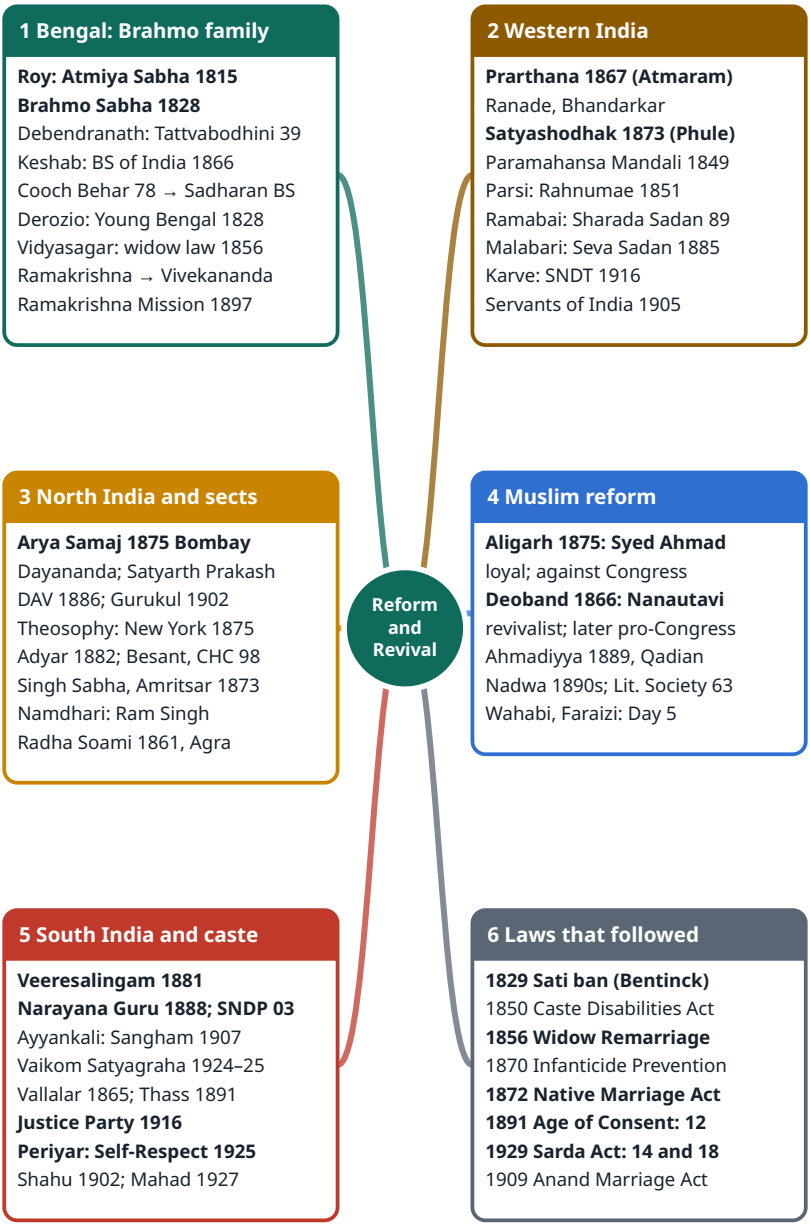
Type	Idea	Examples
Caste and anti-caste	Dignity and rights for lower castes; break the Brahmin monopoly	Satyashodhak Samaj, SNDP, Justice Party, Self-Respect Movement

COMMON THEMES (UPSC ASKS THESE)

- Attacks on idol worship, caste rules, child marriage, sati, polygamy and the ban on widow remarriage.
- Support for women's education and for English or science teaching.
- Use of the press, schools and societies to spread the message.
- Reformers argued from **reason** and from **old texts** together: Roy and Vidyasagar quoted the Shastras; Syed Ahmad quoted the Quran.
- Limits: mostly **urban, upper-caste and middle-class**; peasants and the poor were barely touched until the caste movements.

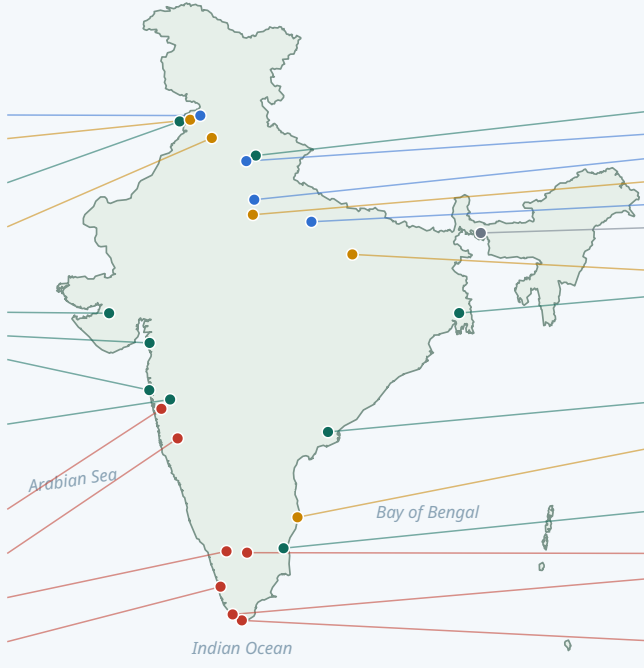
2. Mind map

Read it in 2 minutes. Six families, each with its main movements, founders and years.



3. India map: place, movement and year (turn your phone sideways)

Hindu reform | Muslim reform | Sikh, Parsi, Theosophy, sects | Caste movements | Key event



11 **Qadian:** Ahmadiyya 1889
10 **Amritsar:** Singh Sabha 1873; Khalsa College 1892
9 **Lahore:** Arya Samaj base 1877; DAV 1886
12 **Bhaini Sahib (Ludhiana):** Namdhari (Kuka) 1857–72

8 **Tankara (Morvi):** Dayananda born 1824
4 **Surat:** Manav Dharma Sabha 1844
3 **Bombay:** Parsi Sabha 1851; Prarthana Samaj 1867; Arya Samaj 1875; Seva Sadan 1885; Sharada Sadan 1889
5 **Pune:** Phule school 1848; Sarvajanik Sabha 1870; Satyashodhak 1873; Arya Mahila Samaj 1882; DES 1884; Servants of India 1905
6 **Mahad (Raigad):** Ambedkar's tank satyagraha 1927
7 **Kolhapur:** Shahu's 50% reservation 1902
22 **Nilgiris (Ooty):** Iyothee Thass: Dravida Mahajana Sabha 1891
26 **Vaikom and Perunna:** Vaikom Satyagraha 1924–25; NSS 1914

13 **Haridwar:** Gurukul Kangri 1902
14 **Deoband:** Darul Uloom 1866
15 **Aligarh:** MAO College 1875
16 **Agra:** Radha Soami 1861
17 **Lucknow:** Nadwat-ul-Ulama 1890s
2 **Cooch Behar:** Keshab's daughter wed 1878
18 **Banaras:** Central Hindu College 1898
1 **Calcutta:** Brahmo Sabha 1828; Young Bengal 1828; Tattvabodhini 1839; Vidyasagar widow Act 1856; BS of India 1866; Sadharan BS 1878; Ramakrishna Mission 1897
23 **Rajahmundry:** Veeresalingam: widow remarriage 1881
19 **Madras (Adyar):** Veda Samaj 1864; Theosophical HQ 1882; Justice Party 1916
20 **Vadalur:** Vallalar's Sangam 1865, Salai 1867, Sabha 1872
21 **Erode:** Self-Respect Movement 1925
25 Aruvippuram (Trivandrum area): Narayana Guru 1888; Ayyankali 1893; SNDP 1903
24 **Swamithoppu (Kanyakumari):** Vaikunda Swamikal: Samathuva Samajam 1836

READ THE MAP LIKE THIS

- **Bengal (east):** the oldest reform, 1815 to 1897. Brahmo Samaj, Young Bengal, Vidyasagar, Ramakrishna.
- **Bombay and Pune (west):** Prarthana, Arya Samaj's birth, Phule, Ramabai. Maharashtra is the home of anti-caste thought.
- **Punjab and the Ganga plain (north):** Arya Samaj's stronghold, Singh Sabha, and the Muslim reform belt Deoband–Aligarh–Lucknow.
- **Madras and Kerala (south):** theosophy, Justice Party, Periyar, and the Kerala caste reformers. The south produced the strongest anti-caste politics.

4. Cluster 1: Bengal and the Brahmo family

Raja Ram Mohan Roy and the Brahmo Sabha 1772–1833 1

WHEN	Atmiya Sabha 1815; Brahmo Sabha **20 August 1828**; Brahmo Samaj building at Chitpur opened January 1830.
WHERE	Calcutta. Born at Radhanagar, Hooghly district.
WHY	Hindu society was held by idol worship, sati, polygamy and caste rules. Roy read the Upanishads, the Quran and the Bible and concluded that the true Hindu faith was **monotheism**. He also wanted Indians to learn English, science and modern law.
BY WHOM	**Raja Ram Mohan Roy**. "Raja" was a title from the Mughal emperor Akbar II, whose envoy he became.
KEY PEOPLE	David Hare (watchmaker, Hindu College), William Adam (Unitarian), Dwarkanath Tagore (partner), Alexander Duff (missionary; Roy helped his school in 1830), Governor-General Bentinck (sati ban), Debendranath Tagore (later leader).

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• **One formless God**; worship by prayer and meditation, not idols. • Rejected idol worship, polytheism, sati, polygamy, and priestly ritual. • **Reason plus scripture**: used the Upanishads, the Quran and the Bible (saw Jesus as a moral teacher, not divine). • Women's rights: right to inherit property; against sati and polygamy. • Modern English and science education; wanted Indians in the services (Indianisation). • Press freedom, jury trial, and separation of the executive from the judiciary.
KEY EVENTS	• **1809** *Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin* ("A Gift to Monotheists"), in **Persian with an Arabic preface**, against polytheism. • **1815** Atmiya Sabha, Calcutta. • **1817** Supported the **Hindu College**, founded by David Hare and Hindu elites. Roy did not found it. • **1820** *The Precepts of Jesus*. **1821** Calcutta Unitarian Committee; *Sambad Kaumudi* (Bengali weekly). **1822** *Mirat-ul-Akhbar* (Persian weekly); *Ancient Rights of Females* on inheritance. • **1823** Protested the Licensing Regulations (press curbs) and stopped *Mirat-ul-Akhbar*. Wrote to Amherst against the Sanskrit College plan and asked for English and science. • **1825** Vedanta College. • **1828** Brahmo Sabha founded. **1829** Campaigned against **sati** using the Shastras; Bentinck passed Regulation XVII. • **1830–33** Went to England for Akbar II (a pension case); died at Bristol, 27 Sept 1833.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Atmiya Sabha 1815; Hindu College 1817 (supported); Anglo-Hindu School 1822; Vedanta College 1825; Brahmo Sabha 1828. • Journals: *Brahmanical Magazine* and *Sambad Kaumudi* (1821, Bengali), *Mirat-ul-Akhbar* (1822, Persian). • Books: *Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin* 1809, *Precepts of Jesus* 1820, *Ancient Rights of Females* 1822.

RESULT	The first modern Indian reformer. Called the "Father of Modern India" and "Maker of Modern India" (credit to a pioneer, not a movement of masses). He also asked for jury trial, separation of the executive and the judiciary, and press freedom.
LIMITS	• Small, urban, English-educated, upper-caste following; no mass base. • Did not attack caste as sharply as later reformers. • The Brahmo Samaj split twice after his death.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Roy (Brahmo Sabha 1828) vs Debendranath (Tattvabodhini 1839) vs Keshab (1866). • Hindu College was founded by David Hare and Hindu elites, not Roy. • Roy campaigned against sati, but Bentinck passed the law.
UPSC ASKED	• **2025:** Roy loved Eastern philosophy and also promoted rational, scientific thinking and social equality. Both statements correct. • **2012:** Brahmo Samaj opposed idolatry and the priestly class but did **not** popularise the infallibility of the Vedas (answer: 1 and 2 only). • **2021 Mains:** Young Bengal and Brahmo Samaj (15 marks).
EXAM HOOK	Hindu College = David Hare, not Roy. Brahmo Samaj = Roy (1828), not Debendranath or Keshab. *Tuhfat* is in **Persian**. The title Raja came from Akbar II.

Tattvabodhini Sabha and Debendranath Tagore

1839–1860s 1

WHEN	Tattvabodhini Sabha **1839**. He joined the Brahmo Samaj in **1842** and merged the two. Journal 1843.
WHERE	Calcutta (Jorasanko, the Tagore house).
WHY	After Roy died the Brahmo Sabha was fading. Debendranath wanted a **systematic study of the Upanishads** and a serious reply to Christian missionaries.
BY WHOM	**Debendranath Tagore** (1817–1905), father of Rabindranath.

KEY PEOPLE	Akshay Kumar Dutt (editor), Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (a member), Rajnarain Bose, Keshab Chandra Sen (joined 1857).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Study of the Upanishads; **monotheism**. • Rational enquiry into religion. • Resist Christian missionary conversion. • 1850: Vedas are not infallible; the heart and reason are the authority. • He kept caste markers (sacred thread for Brahmin priests) in practice: a limit that Keshab rejected.
KEY EVENTS	• **1839** Tattvabodhini Sabha. • **1843** *Tattvabodhini Patrika* (editor Akshay Kumar Dutt); a Brahmo covenant (pledge) introduced. • **1850** *Brahmo Dharma*: dropped the belief that the Vedas are infallible. • **1857–65** Keshab's radical ideas (no sacred thread, no Brahmin-only priests) clashed with Debendranath.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Tattvabodhini Sabha 1839; *Tattvabodhini Patrika* 1843 (Akshay Kumar Dutt, editor); *Brahmo Dharma* 1850; Brahmo covenant 1843.
RESULT	Revived the Brahmo Samaj and gave it a text and a journal. His faction, after the 1866 split, became the **Adi Brahmo Samaj**.
LIMITS	• Elite and conservative; clashed with Keshab's radical wing; the movement split in 1866.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Tattvabodhini Sabha (1839) is not the Brahmo Sabha (1828). • Debendranath is not the founder of the Brahmo Samaj.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly as a stem; it appears in "match the following" and in founder-swap options.
EXAM HOOK	Tattvabodhini Sabha = Debendranath (1839). It is a 1839 body, not the 1828 Samaj.

Brahmo Samaj of India (Keshab Chandra Sen)

1866–1884 1

WHEN	**1866** split; Indian Reform Association **1870**; Native Marriage Act **1872**; New Dispensation **1880–81**.
WHERE	Calcutta. Keshab toured Bombay and Madras in 1864 and inspired Prarthana Samaj and Veda Samaj.
WHY	Keshab wanted a universal, caste-free movement open to Christian and other teachings. Debendranath held to the Hindu form (sacred thread, Brahmin priests). The two clashed in 1865 and Keshab left in 1866.
BY WHOM	**Keshab Chandra Sen** (1838–84).
KEY PEOPLE	Keshab; Pratap Chandra Mazumdar and Vijay Krishna Goswami (his colleagues); the Legislative Council (passed the 1872 Act).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• **Universal religion** drawing on Hindu, Christian, Islamic and other teachings. • Opposed caste, sacred thread, child marriage and idolatry; supported women's education, widow remarriage, temperance. • Later claimed divine commands (*adesh*) and a "New Dispensation" that blended faiths.
KEY EVENTS	• **1866** Brahmo Samaj of India founded. • **1870 Indian Reform Association** with five sections: charity, women's improvement, education, cheap literature, temperance. *Sulabh Samachar* (one-paisa paper). • **1872 Native Marriage Act** (Act III): civil marriage for those who did not follow a recognised religion; girls 14, boys 18; banned polygamy. Keshab's campaign. • **1878** He married his 13-year-old daughter to the Maharaja of **Cooch Behar**, against the Act he had won. • **1880–81 Nava Vidhan** (New Dispensation); Tabernacle of the New Dispensation.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Brahmo Samaj of India 1866; Indian Reform Association 1870 (five sections: charity, women, education, cheap literature, temperance); *Sulabh Samachar* 1870; *Indian Mirror* (journal); Tabernacle of New Dispensation 1881.

RESULT	The 1878 marriage lost him his followers and split the Brahmo Samaj again. Still, the movement spread reformist ideas to Bombay, Madras and Punjab.
LIMITS	• Personality cult and claims of divine inspiration alienated followers. • The 1878 Cooch Behar wedding broke the Native Marriage Act's spirit. • Split again in 1878.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Keshab: Indian Reform Association and Tabernacle of New Dispensation. The Calcutta Unitarian Committee was Roy's. • Keshab's campaign gave the 1872 Native Marriage Act; he did not pass the sati ban.
UPSC ASKED	• **2015:** Keshab is associated with the Tabernacle of New Dispensation and the Indian Reform Association, not the Calcutta Unitarian Committee (answer: 2 and 3). • **2005 (wrong statement):** "Keshab's anti-sati campaign led to the ban law." False: the credit belongs to Roy. • **2001:** Under Keshab the Brahmo Samaj campaigned for women's education. True.
EXAM HOOK	UPSC 2015: Keshab set up the **Indian Reform Association** and the Tabernacle of New Dispensation. The Calcutta Unitarian Committee was Roy's.

Sadharan Brahmo Samaj

1878 1 2

WHEN	**15 May 1878**.
WHERE	Calcutta.
WHY	The Cooch Behar marriage broke the age rule that Keshab himself had fought for. Critics also wanted a **democratic constitution**: elected leaders, not a single guru.
BY WHOM	Breakaway Brahmos: **Anand Mohan Bose, Shivnath Shastri, Dwarkanath Ganguly**.
KEY PEOPLE	Anand Mohan Bose (also co-founded the Indian Association in 1876 with Surendranath Banerjea), Shivnath Shastri, Dwarkanath Ganguly (women's causes).

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Elected committee and a democratic constitution instead of one leader. • Strict opposition to child marriage; support for women's emancipation and higher education for women.
KEY EVENTS	• Mar 1878 Cooch Behar wedding. • May 1878 Sadharan Brahmo Samaj formed with a representative constitution.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Sadharan Brahmo Samaj 1878; Bose helped found the Indian Association 1876 (with Surendranath Banerjea).
RESULT	Became the main Brahmo body; supported women's emancipation and the new nationalism. Keshab's group shrank.
LIMITS	• Small, urban membership; Hindu society treated Brahmos as outcasts.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Brahmo of India (1866, Keshab) vs Sadharan (1878, his critics) vs Adi Brahmo Samaj (Debendranath's wing).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Keshab did not found this. His **critics** did.

Young Bengal and Henry Derozio

1826–1831 1

WHEN	Derozio taught **1826–31**; Academic Association 1828; dismissed 1831.
WHERE	Hindu College, Calcutta.
WHY	Western rationalism (Tom Paine, the French Revolution) fired a group of students against idol worship, caste, priests and scriptural authority.
BY WHOM	**Henry Vivian Derozio** (1809–31), an Anglo-Indian teacher, and his students (Derozians).
KEY PEOPLE	Radhanath Sikdar, Krishna Mohan Banerjea, Rasik Krishna Mallik, Dakshinaranjan Mukherjee, Peary Chand Mitra.

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Free thought and rationalism (Tom Paine, French Revolution). • Questioned idol worship, caste, priests and the authority of the scriptures. • Patriotism; freedom of the press; women's education.
KEY EVENTS	• **1828** Academic Association (debating society). • 1830 *Parthenon* (student journal) closed down under pressure. • **1831** Orthodox Hindus forced the college to dismiss him; he died of cholera the same year, aged 22.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Academic Association 1828; *Parthenon* 1830; *Enquirer* (K. M. Banerjea); *Gyananveshan* (Dakshinaranjan Mukherjee); Society for the Acquisition of General Knowledge 1838.
RESULT	Radical in ideas but had no mass base and no link to peasants. Many Derozians became leaders of later reform and journalism.
LIMITS	• No link with peasants or the masses; radical in words only. • Cut off from Hindu society; faded after Derozio's death.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Young Bengal (radical, Hindu College) vs Brahmo Samaj (a religious reform body). • Derozio is not a founder of the Hindu College.
UPSC ASKED	• **2021 Mains:** Rise and growth of reform movements with reference to Young Bengal and Brahmo Samaj.
EXAM HOOK	Derozio = Young Bengal = Hindu College. Radical, not revivalist.

Dharma Sabha (the orthodox answer) 1830 1

WHEN	**1830**.
WHERE	Calcutta.
WHY	To **defend sati** and Hindu custom against Roy, Bentinck and the reformers.
BY WHOM	**Radhakanta Deb** and Bhabanicharan Bandopadhyay.

KEY PEOPLE	Radhakanta Deb (also backed women's education and the Hindu College; first president of the British Indian Association, 1851).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Defence of sati and orthodox custom as sanctioned by the Shastras. • Not against English education (Deb supported the Hindu College).
KEY EVENTS	• Petitioned Parliament and the Privy Council against the 1829 sati ban. The Privy Council **rejected** the appeal in 1832.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Dharma Sabha 1830; *Samachar Chandrika* (Bhabanicharan Bandopadhyay's paper).
RESULT	Lost the case; sati stayed banned. Shows that reform met organised opposition.
LIMITS	• Lost the Privy Council appeal in 1832; fought a losing cause.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Dharma Sabha (orthodox) vs Brahmo Sabha (reform): opposite sides of the sati debate.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Dharma Sabha opposed Roy; it did not support the sati ban.

Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and the widow remarriage law

1820–1891 1

WHEN	Campaign 1850s; petition **1855**; **Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act, 26 July 1856**.
WHERE	Calcutta (born at Birsingha, Midnapore).
WHY	Child widows, many aged 8 to 12, lived under the strict rules of enforced widowhood. Vidyasagar showed from texts (the **Parashara Smriti**) that remarriage was permitted.
BY WHOM	**Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**.
KEY PEOPLE	Vidyasagar; Lord Dalhousie (prepared the bill); Canning (enacted it); J. E. D. Bethune (girls' school); Srishchandra Vidyaratna (first groom).

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Widow remarriage is permitted by the Shastras (*Parashara Smriti*). • Opposed child marriage and kulin polygamy. • Women's education; non-Brahmins admitted to Sanskrit College; modern, secular teaching. • Simple Bengali prose.
KEY EVENTS	• **1849** Bethune School (first girls' school in India run on public lines): Vidyasagar was **Secretary**. • **1851** Principal of Sanskrit College; opened it to non-Brahmins. • **1855** Petition with **987 signatures** to the government; *Barnaparichay* (Bengali primer) written the same year. • **1856** The Act. First legal widow remarriage on 7 Dec 1856. • Opened about 35 girls' schools in Bengal districts; campaigned against child marriage and kulin polygamy. • **1872** Metropolitan Institution (first college run by Indians).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Bethune School 1849 (Secretary); Sanskrit College principal 1851; about 35 girls' schools; Metropolitan Institution 1872; *Barnaparichay* 1855; 1855 petition with 987 signatures.
RESULT	The Act removed the legal bar; the social bar remained for decades because families still outcast the remarried. Few widows remarried.
LIMITS	• Very few widows remarried; society still outcast them. • He felt let down by many reformers and withdrew from public life late in life.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Vidyasagar (1856 Act) vs Roy (1829 sati ban) vs Karve (widow education, 1890s) vs Veeresalingam (Telugu, 1881).
UPSC ASKED	• **2021:** Vidyasagar was Secretary of the Hindu Female School, later Bethune School. • **2005:** Vidyasagar is credited with the Bethune School (a statement marked correct). • **2019 Mains:** How far was the widow remarriage movement effective? • **2017 Mains:** The women's question in 19th-century reform (sati, widow remarriage, education).

EXAM HOOK	Vidyasagar = Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act 1856. He was Secretary of the Hindu (Bethune) Female School, UPSC 2021.

Ramakrishna, Vivekananda and the Ramakrishna Mission

1836–1902 1

WHEN	Ramakrishna 1836–86. Vivekananda 1863–1902. Chicago **11 Sept 1893**. Mission **1 May 1897**.
WHERE	Dakshineswar (Calcutta); Belur Math (HQ from 1899); Mayavati (Advaita Ashrama, 1899).
WHY	Educated Hindus felt shamed by missionary criticism of Hinduism. Vivekananda gave them pride in Vedanta and a mission of service.
BY WHOM	Ramakrishna taught; **Narendranath Datta (Swami Vivekananda)** built the movement.
KEY PEOPLE	Ramakrishna Paramahamsa (priest, Dakshineswar Kali temple), Sarada Devi, Sister Nivedita (Margaret Noble), Vivekananda.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• *Yato mat tato path*: all religions lead to God. • **Practical Vedanta**; service to man is service to God (*Daridra Narayana*). • Spiritual strength and character; pride in India's heritage; action over ritual.
KEY EVENTS	• **1893** Spoke at the Parliament of Religions, Chicago. • **1896** *Prabuddha Bharata* (English journal). **1899** *Udbodhan* (Bengali). • **1897** Ramakrishna Mission, Calcutta; later HQ at Belur. • Teaching: "all religions are paths to one goal"; **Practical Vedanta**; service to the poor as service to God (*Daridra Narayana*). • Died 4 July 1902.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Math at Baranagar 1886–87; Ramakrishna Mission 1897; Belur Math 1899; Advaita Ashrama, Mayavati 1899; *Prabuddha Bharata* 1896; *Udbodhan* 1899; books *Raja Yoga*, *Karma Yoga*, *Jnana Yoga*, *Bhakti Yoga*; *Kathamrita* (by "M").
RESULT	Revived Hindu self-respect; set up schools, hospitals and relief work; inspired young nationalists.

LIMITS	• Hindu-centric; limited legal or political reform; criticised for the "spiritual East, material West" idea.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Ramakrishna Mission (1897, Vivekananda) is not Arya Samaj (Dayananda). • Chicago address 1893 vs Mission 1897.
UPSC ASKED	• **2014 Mains:** "Ramakrishna became the prophet of neo-Hinduism but never claimed to found a new religion." • **2013 Mains:** Vivekananda on India's ancient spirituality and modern needs.
EXAM HOOK	Ramakrishna Mission = Vivekananda (1897). Chicago = 1893.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 1

1. Who founded the Brahmo Sabha and when? (Roy, 1828)
2. Which Tagore founded the Tattvabodhini Sabha? (Debendranath, 1839)
3. Which Act did Keshab's campaign win and what ages did it fix? (Native Marriage Act 1872; 14 girls and 18 boys)
4. What split the Brahmo Samaj in 1878? (Cooch Behar marriage; Sadharan Brahmo Samaj)
5. Which Act did Vidyasagar's campaign win? (Widows' Remarriage Act 1856)

5. Cluster 2: Western India

Manav Dharma Sabha and Paramahansa Mandali

1844 and 1849 4 3

WHEN	Manav Dharma Sabha **1844**; Paramahansa Mandali **1849**.
WHERE	Surat (1844), later Bombay; Paramahansa Mandali in Bombay and Maharashtra.
WHY	To end caste, idol worship and the priest's control; to allow widow remarriage and women's education.

BY WHOM	Durgaram Mehtaji and **Dadoba Pandurang** (Manav Dharma Sabha); Dadoba Pandurang, Ram Balkrishna Jaykar and others (Paramahansa Mandali).
KEY PEOPLE	Durgaram Mehtaji, Dadoba Pandurang, Atmaram Pandurang (Dadoba's brother, later Prarthana Samaj founder).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• One God; end caste; widow remarriage; women's education; communal meals across castes.
KEY EVENTS	• Manav Dharma Sabha: monotheism and anti-caste. • Paramahansa Mandali: a **secret** society. Members ate food cooked by lower castes to break caste rules.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Manav Dharma Sabha 1844; Paramahansa Mandali 1849; *Dharma Vivechan* (Dadoba Pandurang, 1848).
RESULT	Both faded when members' names leaked and orthodox pressure grew. They are the **forerunners** of Prarthana Samaj.
LIMITS	• Secret and short-lived; collapsed when members were exposed.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Paramahansa Mandali (Maharashtra, 1849) has nothing to do with Ramakrishna Paramahamsa.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Early Western India bodies came **before** Prarthana (1867) and Arya Samaj (1875).

Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha (Parsi reform) 1851 3

WHEN	**1851**.
WHERE	Bombay.
WHY	To reform Parsi religious practice, raise the status of women, and remove customs borrowed from outside.
BY WHOM	Naoroji Furdunji, **Dadabhai Naoroji**, K. R. Cama, S. S. Bengalee.
KEY PEOPLE	Dadabhai Naoroji (Grand Old Man of India), K. R. Cama (scholar), S. S. Bengalee (women's causes).

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Modernise Zoroastrian practice; improve women's status; educate Parsi girls.
KEY EVENTS	• Newspaper *Rast Goftar* (1851), edited by Naoroji. • 1848 Students' Literary and Scientific Society (Naoroji): promoted girls' schools.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha 1851; *Rast Goftar* 1851; Students' Literary and Scientific Society 1848.
RESULT	Parsi Marriage and Divorce Act **1865**. Parsis became the most modernised community of Bombay.
LIMITS	• Limited to the Parsi community.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• A Parsi body, not a Hindu one. Naoroji ran *Rast Goftar*.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Parsi reform = Rahnumae Mazdayasnan, 1851, paper *Rast Goftar*.

Prarthana Samaj

1867 3

WHEN	**31 March 1867**.
WHERE	Bombay.
WHY	Keshab Chandra Sen's visit to Bombay in 1864 inspired local reformers. But they chose not to break with Hinduism.
BY WHOM	**Atmaram Pandurang** (a doctor) with Keshab's encouragement.
KEY PEOPLE	Atmaram Pandurang, **M. G. Ranade**, **R. G. Bhandarkar**, N. G. Chandavarkar, K. T. Telang, V. R. Shinde (later).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Worship of one God by prayer (*prarthana*) and bhajans. • Reform inside Hinduism, built on the Maharashtra saints (Tukaram, Ramdas). • Against caste, child marriage and enforced widowhood; for widow remarriage, women's education and an end to the ban on overseas travel.

KEY EVENTS	• Reform stayed **inside Hinduism**, drawing on Maharashtra's bhakti saints (Tukaram, Ramdas, Namdev) rather than on the Vedas alone. • Worship of one God; opposed caste, child marriage and enforced widowhood; supported widow remarriage and women's education. • Night schools, orphanages, a Depressed Classes Mission (1906, V. R. Shinde).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Prarthana Samaj 1867; night schools; orphanages; Depressed Classes Mission 1906 (V. R. Shinde); *Subodh Patrika* (journal).
RESULT	Spread social reform in Maharashtra; its leaders (Ranade) later shaped the National Social Conference.
LIMITS	• Elite and urban; more social service than doctrine; did not break Brahmin leadership.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Prarthana (Bombay 1867, Hindu fold) vs Brahmo (Calcutta) vs Arya Samaj (Bombay 1875, Vedic).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct stem in recent Prelims; appears in match-the-following (Prarthana–Atmaram Pandurang).
EXAM HOOK	Prarthana Samaj = Atmaram Pandurang, Bombay 1867. It was not Phule's, and it was not Brahmo.

M. G. Ranade and the reform leaders around him

1842–1901 **5**

WHEN	1860s to 1901.
WHERE	Pune and Bombay.
WHY	He wanted gradual social reform and economic nationalism through institutions.
BY WHOM	**Mahadev Govind Ranade**.
KEY PEOPLE	Ranade, G. K. Gokhale (his disciple), Tilak, Agarkar and Chiplunkar (Deccan Education Society).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Gradual reform from within; link social reform with economic nationalism (swadeshi, Indian industry). • Against child marriage; for widow remarriage and women's education.

KEY EVENTS	• Widow Marriage Association (1861, in Spectrum's dating). • **1870** Poona Sarvajanik Sabha. • **1884** Deccan Education Society was founded by **Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar**; Ranade supported it. • **1887 National Social Conference** (met alongside the Congress). • Books: *Rise of the Maratha Power*; *Essays on Indian Economics*.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Poona Sarvajanik Sabha 1870; National Social Conference 1887; Industrial Conference 1890; *Rise of the Maratha Power*; *Essays on Indian Economics*.
RESULT	The "intellectual father" of Indian liberalism; he trained Gokhale.
LIMITS	• Cautious and gradual; Congress kept social reform out of its agenda.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Deccan Education Society founders: Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar (Ranade supported).
UPSC ASKED	• **2014:** National Social Conference was formed because the Congress did not want to take up social reform (answer: a separate body for that purpose).
EXAM HOOK	Deccan Education Society = Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar, not Ranade.

Satyashodhak Samaj and Jyotirao Phule

1827–1890 **5**

WHEN	**24 September 1873**. Phule's work from 1848.
WHERE	Pune.
WHY	Brahmin control of religion, learning and jobs kept Shudras and Ati-Shudras (untouchables) in "slavery" in Phule's view. Their remedy was education and an end to priestly mediation.
BY WHOM	**Jyotirao Phule** with his wife **Savitribai Phule**.
KEY PEOPLE	Jyotirao Phule; Savitribai Phule (first woman teacher); Fatima Sheikh (Muslim woman teacher); Krishnarao Bhalekar (*Dinbandhu*); later Shahu Maharaj.

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• **Anti-Brahmin**: Brahmin priests were an outside (Aryan) group that enslaved Shudras and Ati-Shudras. • Truth-seeking (*satyashodhak*); equality of all humans; no priestly mediation. • Education for girls, Shudras and untouchables; farmers' welfare; widow remarriage.
KEY EVENTS	• **1848** First girls' school in Pune (Bhidewada) with Savitribai. • **1863** Home for the prevention of infanticide. • **1868** Opened his own water tank to untouchables. • **1873** Founded the Samaj. Wrote ***Gulamgiri*** (Slavery), dedicated to the American abolitionists. • **1881** *Shetkaryacha Asud* (Cultivator's Whipcord). • **1888** Given the title **Mahatma** by Vithalrao Vandekar. • 1882 Sent a memorandum to the Hunter Commission asking for primary education for the poor.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Satyashodhak Samaj 1873; *Gulamgiri* 1873; *Shetkaryacha Asud* 1881; *Tritiya Ratna* 1855; *Dinbandhu* 1877; *Sarvajanik Satya Dharma Pustak* 1891; girls' school 1848; Home for infanticide prevention 1863.
RESULT	Started the non-Brahmin movement of Maharashtra. The Samaj later split but its ideas passed to Shahu Maharaj and Ambedkar.
LIMITS	• Later led by Marathas; reach beyond Maharashtra was limited; split after Phule's death.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Satyashodhak (Phule, Pune) vs Prarthana (Bombay); Tilak is not linked to Satyashodhak.
UPSC ASKED	• **2016:** Satya Shodhak Samaj organised an anti-caste movement in Maharashtra. • **1995 (mismatch):** Tilak–Satya Shodhak Sabha is wrong. • **2025 Mains:** Phule's writings and social reform efforts (15 marks).
EXAM HOOK	Satyashodhak = Pune 1873 (UPSC 2016: an anti-caste movement). *Gulamgiri* = Phule.

Pandita Ramabai

1858–1922 5 3

WHEN	Arya Mahila Samaj **1882**; Sharada Sadan **1889**; Mukti Mission **1896**.
WHERE	Pune, Bombay; Kedgaon (Mukti).
WHY	The suffering of high-caste widows. Ramabai herself was a widow and a scholar of Sanskrit.
BY WHOM	**Pandita Ramabai Saraswati**.
KEY PEOPLE	Ramabai; M. G. Ranade (supporter); Sarada Sadan's first students and teachers.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Education and economic independence for women, especially widows. • Criticised the treatment of high-caste Hindu women.
KEY EVENTS	• **1882** Arya Mahila Samaj, Pune; gave evidence to the Hunter Commission on women's education. • **1883** Converted to Christianity in England. • **1887** *The High Caste Hindu Woman*. • **1889** Sharada Sadan, Bombay (moved to Pune 1890): a home and school for widows. She attended the Congress session of 1889. • **1896** Mukti Mission, Kedgaon.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Arya Mahila Samaj 1882; *The High Caste Hindu Woman* 1887; Sharada Sadan 1889; Mukti Mission 1896.
RESULT	Early example of women organising for women; Sharada Sadan trained widows as teachers and nurses.
LIMITS	• Her conversion (1883) distanced her from many Hindu reformers.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Pandita Ramabai is not Rakhmabai (the 1884 case about conjugal rights and age of consent).
UPSC ASKED	• **2020:** The Rakhmabai case (1884) concerned the age of consent and restitution of conjugal rights, not women's education.
EXAM HOOK	Ramabai: Arya Mahila Samaj 1882; Sharada Sadan 1889; book 1887.

B. M. Malabari and Seva Sadan

1853–1912 **3**

WHEN	Notes 1884; Seva Sadan **1885**; Age of Consent Act **1891**.
WHERE	Bombay.
WHY	Child brides and enforced widowhood. Cases like the Rakhmabai case (1884–88) and the death of a ten-year-old girl, Phulmoni Dasi, in 1889 made reform urgent.
BY WHOM	Behramji Malabari (Parsi journalist, editor of *Indian Spectator*) with Dayaram Gidumal.
KEY PEOPLE	Malabari, Dayaram Gidumal, Rakhmabai, Ranade.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Ban child marriage; protect widows; raise the age of consent.
KEY EVENTS	• **1884** *Notes on Infant Marriage and Enforced Widowhood*. • **1884–88 Rakhmabai case**: she refused to live with a husband married to her as a child; the court case on **restitution of conjugal rights** (UPSC 2020). • **1885** Seva Sadan: a home for destitute women.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• *Notes on Infant Marriage and Enforced Widowhood* 1884; Seva Sadan 1885; *Indian Spectator* (his paper).
RESULT	**Age of Consent Act 1891**: raised the age from 10 to **12** (not 14).
LIMITS	• The 1891 Act raised the age only to 12, and it was weakly enforced.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Malabari (Parsi, Seva Sadan) vs Karve (widow home, SNDT) vs Ramabai (Sharada Sadan).
UPSC ASKED	• **2020:** Rakhmabai case 1884 (age of consent and conjugal rights).
EXAM HOOK	Malabari = Seva Sadan. 1891 = age of consent 12.

D. K. Karve and women's education

1858–1962 **5**

WHEN	Widows' Marriage Association 1893; Widows' Home **1899**; SNDT **1916**.
WHERE	Pune (Hingne).

WHY	Widows needed shelter, education and a way to earn.
BY WHOM	**Dhondo Keshav Karve**, who himself married a widow in 1893.
KEY PEOPLE	Karve; M. G. Ranade; Vidyasagar (inspiration).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Training widows to become teachers and nurses; women's higher education.
KEY EVENTS	• **1896** Anath Balikashram (orphan girls). • **1899** Hindu Widows' Home, Hingne. • **1916 SNDT Women's University** (first women's university in India).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Widow Marriage Association 1893; Widows' Home 1899; SNDT Women's University 1916.
RESULT	Bharat Ratna 1958.
LIMITS	• Orthodox opposition; the work stayed small until SNDT.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Karve (Pune, 1890s onwards) vs Vidyasagar (Bengal, 1856 Act).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	SNDT = Karve 1916.

Servants of India Society and Social Service League

1905 and 1911 5 3

WHEN	**1905** and **1911**.
WHERE	Pune; Bombay.
WHY	To train full-time workers for national and social service.
BY WHOM	**G. K. Gokhale** (Servants of India); **N. M. Joshi** (Social Service League).
KEY PEOPLE	Gokhale, V. S. Srinivasa Sastri, H. N. Kunzru, N. M. Joshi.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Service to the nation as a religion; vows of poverty; education, famine relief, labour welfare.
KEY EVENTS	• Members took vows of poverty and service; work for education, labour, tribals and famine relief.

INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Servants of India Society 1905; Social Service League 1911.
RESULT	Models for later welfare work; Joshi founded the trade union movement in Bombay.
LIMITS	• Few full-time members; moderate, non-agitational.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Servants of India Society (Gokhale) vs Deccan Education Society (Tilak, Agarkar).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Servants of India = Gokhale, Pune, 1905.

Gopal Baba Walangkar and Shahu Maharaj

1888 and 1902 5 7

WHEN	Vital-Vidhvansak **1888**; Anarya Dosh Pariharak Mandali **1890**; Kolhapur reservation **1902**.
WHERE	Maharashtra (Walangkar); Kolhapur (Shahu).
WHY	Untouchables and non-Brahmins were shut out of education, jobs and temples.
BY WHOM	**Gopal Baba Walangkar**, an ex-soldier; **Chhatrapati Shahu Maharaj**, the ruler of Kolhapur.
KEY PEOPLE	Walangkar, Shivram Janba Kamble, Shahu Maharaj, Dr Ambedkar (Shahu's friend).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Dignity for untouchables; reservation; free and compulsory primary education.
KEY EVENTS	• **1888** *Vital-Vidhvansak*, the first journal for untouchables (UPSC 2020). • **1902** Shahu reserved **50% of state posts** for backward classes. This is the first reservation by a state in India. • Free primary education (1917); hostels for backward classes.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• *Vital-Vidhvansak* 1888; Anarya Dosh Pariharak Mandali 1890; Kolhapur reservation order 1902; hostels for backward classes.

RESULT	Early form of reservation policy; Shahu supported Phule's Satyashodhak movement and Ambedkar.
LIMITS	• Walangkar's efforts were limited to petitions; Shahu's reach was within his own state.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Walangkar (*Vital-Vidhvansak*) vs Phule (*Gulamgiri*) vs Ambedkar (*Mooknayak*).
UPSC ASKED	• **2020:** *Vital-Vidhvansak*, the first monthly journal for untouchables, was published by Gopal Baba Walangkar.
EXAM HOOK	*Vital-Vidhvansak* = Walangkar. 1902 reservation = Shahu.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 2

1. Founder and year of Prarthana Samaj? (Atmaram Pandurang, 1867)
2. Who founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and where? (Phule, Pune, 1873)
3. Which book is Phule's? (*Gulamgiri*)
4. Who started Sharada Sadan? (Ramabai, 1889)
5. Who set up the Deccan Education Society? (Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar, 1884)

6. Cluster 3: North India, Sikh, Theosophy and sects

Arya Samaj (Dayananda Saraswati) 1824–1883 8 3 9 13	
WHEN	Samaj founded **10 April 1875**; Lahore base 1877; DAV 1886; Gurukul Kangri 1902.
WHERE	**Bombay** (not Lahore). Dayananda was born at Tankara, Gujarat. Strongest in Punjab and the United Provinces.
WHY	Missionary attacks on Hinduism and a fall into ritual, idols, caste and priestly greed. Dayananda wanted a return to the pure **Vedic** religion.
BY WHOM	**Dayananda Saraswati** (born Mool Shankar). His guru: Swami Virjananda of Mathura.

KEY PEOPLE	Lala Hansraj, Lala Lajpat Rai, Pandit Guru Datt, Lekh Ram, **Swami Shraddhanand (Munshi Ram)**, Shyamji Krishna Varma.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• **The Vedas are infallible**: "back to the Vedas". • One God; rejected idol worship, polytheism, avatars, priestly rituals and caste by birth. • Karma and rebirth; God, soul and matter are eternal. • Widow remarriage, women's education, Hindi, swadeshi; **Shuddhi** for those who left Hinduism.
KEY EVENTS	• **1875** *Satyarth Prakash* in **Hindi**. Slogan: "Go back to the Vedas". • Rejected idol worship, polytheism, priestly dominance, avatars, and caste by birth. Supported widow remarriage and women's education; held that the soul and matter are eternal. • **Shuddhi**: ritual of re-entry into Hinduism for converts. • **1886** DAV (Dayanand Anglo-Vedic) School, Lahore; Lala Hansraj principal. • **1893** Split: "College" party (English education) versus "Gurukul" party (traditional). • **1902** Gurukul Kangri, Haridwar (Munshi Ram). • Died 1883 at Ajmer (after poisoning at Jodhpur).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Arya Samaj 1875; Paropkarini Sabha 1880; DAV School, Lahore 1886; Gurukul Kangri 1902; *Satyarth Prakash* (Hindi, 1875); *Veda Bhashya*.
RESULT	The most aggressive revivalist movement; shaped Punjab politics and became a nursery of nationalists.
LIMITS	• Aggressive towards Islam and Christianity; Shuddhi added to communal tension. • The 1893 split between "college" and "gurukul" parties.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Arya Samaj (Bombay 1875, Vedic) vs Brahmo (Calcutta, Upanishadic and rational) vs Theosophical (New York). • Dayananda is not Vivekananda.
UPSC ASKED	• **2001:** Arya Samaj was founded in 1875, not 1835. • **2018:** In an order-of-events question, Arya Samaj (1875) came after *Neel Darpan* and the first Indian ICS success (1863), but before *Anandamath* (1882).

EXAM HOOK	Arya Samaj: Bombay 1875, not Lahore. *Satyarth Prakash* in Hindi. Dayananda rejected avatars.

Theosophical Society

1875–1933 19 18

WHEN	New York **17 Nov 1875**. India 1879. Adyar HQ **1882**. Besant president **1907**.
WHERE	New York; Bombay (1879); Adyar, Madras.
WHY	A universal movement to revive and respect the old Eastern religions: Hinduism, Buddhism, Zoroastrianism.
BY WHOM	**Madame H. P. Blavatsky** and **Colonel H. S. Olcott**.
KEY PEOPLE	Blavatsky (died 1891), Olcott (president till 1907), **Annie Besant**, Bhagwan Das.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Universal brotherhood; comparative study of religion; karma and reincarnation; revival of the old Eastern faiths.
KEY EVENTS	• **1882** HQ shifted to Adyar. • **1893** Besant came to India. • **1898 Central Hindu College, Banaras** (Besant); later the core of Banaras Hindu University. • **1916** Besant launched the **Home Rule League** and later the paper *New India*. • **1917** Besant was the **first woman President of the Congress** (Calcutta).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Theosophical Society 1875; Adyar HQ 1882; Central Hindu College 1898; *New India* (daily) and *Commonweal*; Home Rule League 1916.
RESULT	Gave educated Hindus pride in their heritage and helped Besant enter nationalist politics.
LIMITS	• Occult and elite; popular among a small educated group.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Besant did not found the Society; Blavatsky and Olcott did. Besant's Home Rule League (Sept 1916) is separate from Tilak's (April 1916).
UPSC ASKED	• No direct recent stem; Besant as first woman Congress President (1917) is a standard question.

EXAM HOOK	Besant did not found the Theosophical Society. The Society began in New York.

Singh Sabha Movement

1873–1902 10 9

WHEN	Amritsar **1873**; Lahore Singh Sabha 1879; Khalsa College **1892**; Chief Khalsa Diwan 1902.
WHERE	Amritsar; Lahore.
WHY	Christian missionaries had converted Sikh students at Amritsar, and the Arya Samaj was pulling Sikhs. Sikhs wanted to purify their religion and teach modern subjects.
BY WHOM	Thakur Singh Sandhawalia, Giani Gian Singh, Kanwar Bikram Singh (Kapurthala).
KEY PEOPLE	Thakur Singh Sandhawalia, Gurmukh Singh (Lahore), Gian Singh, Bhai Vir Singh.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Revive pure Sikh practice; assert a separate Sikh identity; modern education.
KEY EVENTS	• **1873** Singh Sabha, Amritsar. • **1879** Lahore Singh Sabha. • **1892** Khalsa College, Amritsar. • **1902** Chief Khalsa Diwan. • **1909** Anand Marriage Act recognised Sikh marriage.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Singh Sabha 1873; Lahore Singh Sabha 1879; Khalsa College 1892; Chief Khalsa Diwan 1902; Anand Marriage Act 1909.
RESULT	Led to the later Gurdwara reform (Akali) movement: SGPC 1920, Nankana Sahib massacre 1921, Sikh Gurdwaras Act 1925.
LIMITS	• Widened the gap between Sikh and Hindu identity.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Singh Sabha (Amritsar 1873) vs Namdhari (Ram Singh) vs Nirankari.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Singh Sabha ≠ Namdhari. Khalsa College, Amritsar 1892.

Namdhari (Kuka) movement

1857–1872 12

WHEN	Under Ram Singh from **1857**; clash **1872**.
WHERE	Bhaini Sahib, Ludhiana, Punjab.
WHY	To purify Sikh practice and also to oppose British rule.
BY WHOM	**Baba Ram Singh** (following Baba Balak Singh).
KEY PEOPLE	Baba Ram Singh.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Strict Sikh code; vegetarian; against caste and dowry; boycott of British institutions.
KEY EVENTS	• Boycott of British courts, schools, post and mill cloth: an early non-cooperation. • **1872** Revolt at Malerkotla; about 65 Kukas blown from guns; Ram Singh exiled to Rangoon.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• No major institutions; HQ at Bhaini Sahib.
RESULT	Crushed, but it was an early model of boycott.
LIMITS	• Crushed in 1872; leaders exiled.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Ram Singh (Namdhari) is not the Singh Sabha.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly; appears with Day 5 peasant movements.
EXAM HOOK	Ram Singh = Namdhari. Singh Sabha = a different movement.

Radha Soami Satsang and Deva Samaj

1861 and 1887 16 9

WHEN	Radha Soami **1861**; Deva Samaj **1887**.
WHERE	Agra; Lahore.
WHY	Spiritual movements that put the guru and ethical living above caste and ritual.
BY WHOM	**Shiv Dayal Saheb** (Radha Soami); **Shiv Narayan Agnihotri** (Deva Samaj; earlier a Brahmo).
KEY PEOPLE	Shiv Dayal Saheb, Jaimal Singh (later Beas dera), Shiv Narayan Agnihotri.

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Radha Soami: devotion to a living guru and *surat shabd yoga*; no caste. Deva Samaj: ethical living and the "Deva Shastra".
KEY EVENTS	• Radha Soami: began Basant Panchami 1861 at Agra; teaches *surat shabd yoga*. • Deva Samaj: stressed ethics and the "Deva Shastra".
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Radha Soami Satsang 1861 (Agra); Deva Samaj 1887 (Lahore).
RESULT	Small movements, but UPSC lists them in "match the following".
LIMITS	• Small sects.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Radha Soami (Agra) vs Deva Samaj (Lahore) vs Arya Samaj (Lahore base).
UPSC ASKED	• Appears in "match the following" lists.
EXAM HOOK	Radha Soami = Agra 1861. Deva Samaj = Lahore 1887.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 3

1. Where was the Arya Samaj founded and in which year? (Bombay, 1875)
2. Which language is *Satyarth Prakash* written in? (Hindi)
3. Who founded the Theosophical Society and where? (Blavatsky and Olcott, New York, 1875)
4. Which college did Besant found in Banaras? (Central Hindu College, 1898)
5. Who led the Namdhari movement? (Baba Ram Singh)

7. Cluster 4: Muslim reform movements

Muhammadan Literary Society — 1863 (1)

WHEN	**1863**.
WHERE	Calcutta.
WHY	To bring modern education and Western knowledge to upper-class Muslims after 1857.

BY WHOM	**Nawab Abdul Latif**.
KEY PEOPLE	Abdul Latif; later Syed Ameer Ali (Central National Muhammadan Association, 1877).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Modern education for Muslims; loyalty to British rule.
KEY EVENTS	• Debates, English education and loyalty to British rule.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Muhammadan Literary Society 1863; Central National Muhammadan Association 1877 (Syed Ameer Ali).
RESULT	An early step; Aligarh carried it far further.
LIMITS	• Elite; Bengal-centred.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Abdul Latif (Calcutta, 1863) vs Syed Ahmad Khan (Aligarh, 1875).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Muhammadan Literary Society = Calcutta, Abdul Latif.

Aligarh Movement (Syed Ahmad Khan) 1817–1898 15

WHEN	Scientific Society **1864**; *Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq* 1870; MAO College **1875**; Educational Conference **1886**.
WHERE	Ghazipur, then Aligarh (United Provinces).
WHY	After 1857 Muslims were seen as rebels and fell behind in education and jobs. Syed Ahmad wanted them to learn English and science **without giving up Islam**.
BY WHOM	**Syed Ahmad Khan** (Sir, 1888).
KEY PEOPLE	Syed Ahmad Khan, Theodore Beck (principal), Mohsin-ul-Mulk, Altaf Hussain Hali (poet), Shibli Nomani (taught).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Rational reading of the Quran; Western science; Urdu and English; loyalty to British rule. • Muslims should stay away from the Congress.

KEY EVENTS	• **1859** *Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hind* (Causes of the Indian Revolt): defended Muslims. • **1864** Scientific Society (translated Western works into Urdu). • **1866** *Aligarh Institute Gazette*; **1870** *Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq* (Social Reformer). • **1875** Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College (became AMU in **1920**). • **1886** Mohammedan Educational Conference. • **1888** Patriotic Association: urged Muslims to **stay away from the Congress**.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• *Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hind* 1859; Scientific Society 1864; *Aligarh Institute Gazette* 1866; *Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq* 1870; MAO College 1875; Educational Conference 1886; Patriotic Association 1888.
RESULT	Created a modern Muslim middle class; loyal to the British; its politics fed the later Muslim League.
LIMITS	• Confined to the upper and middle Muslim class; its politics fed separatism.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Syed Ahmad Khan (Aligarh) is not Syed Ahmad of Rae Bareli (Wahabi). • Aligarh (modern, loyal) vs Deoband (pure religion).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly in recent Prelims; frequent in coaching tests.
EXAM HOOK	Syed Ahmad Khan: Aligarh, loyal, against the Congress. Deoband **opposed** his approach.

Deoband School

1866 14

WHEN	**30 May 1866**.
WHERE	Deoband, Saharanpur district, United Provinces.
WHY	After 1857, to protect Islam under non-Muslim rule by teaching the Quran, hadith and law. It refused government funds and ran on public donations.
BY WHOM	**Muhammad Qasim Nanautavi** and **Rashid Ahmad Gangohi**.
KEY PEOPLE	Nanautavi, Gangohi, **Mahmud-ul-Hasan** (Deoband's first student, later Sheikh-ul-Hind), Hussain Ahmad Madani.

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Revive pure Islam; Quran and hadith; no Western learning; no government aid. • Later: composite nationalism and support to the Congress.
KEY EVENTS	• **1916** Silk Letter Conspiracy (Mahmud-ul-Hasan). • **1919** Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind formed.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Darul Uloom 1866; Silk Letter Movement 1916; Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind 1919.
RESULT	Revivalist: pure Islamic teaching and no Western education. It **opposed** Aligarh's loyalism and later supported the Congress and composite nationalism.
LIMITS	• Conservative; limited secular education.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Deoband vs Barelvi; Deoband vs Aligarh; Deoband vs the Wahabis of Syed Ahmad.
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Deoband vs Aligarh: pure religious revival versus modern education plus loyalty.

Ahmadiyya Movement

1889 11

WHEN	Pledge taken **23 March 1889** at Ludhiana; Qadian base.
WHERE	Qadian, Punjab.
WHY	To defend Islam against Christian missionaries and Arya Samaj debates, and to renew faith.
BY WHOM	**Mirza Ghulam Ahmad** (1835–1908).
KEY PEOPLE	Mirza Ghulam Ahmad; Maulvi Nuruddin (first successor).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• A renewal of Islam, a peaceful interpretation against armed jihad, and a claim of divine guidance.
KEY EVENTS	• He claimed to be a divinely guided reformer and Messiah (1891); this caused opposition from other Muslim groups. • Split into Qadian and Lahore groups in 1914.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Qadian base; split into Qadian and Lahore groups in 1914.

RESULT	A separate community from the rest of Islam in the eyes of most Muslim groups; it was active in publishing and missions.
LIMITS	• Most Muslim groups rejected its claims; it stayed a distinct community.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Ahmadiyya (Qadian, 1889) vs Deoband (1866) vs Aligarh (1875).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Ahmadiyya = Qadian 1889.

Nadwat-ul-Ulama

1890s 17

WHEN	Conference 1894; Darul Uloom Nadwa 1898.
WHERE	Kanpur (first meeting), then Lucknow.
WHY	To reform the madrasa syllabus: combine religious and modern subjects and unite sects.
BY WHOM	Muhammad Ali Mungeri, **Shibli Nomani**.
KEY PEOPLE	Shibli Nomani, Muhammad Ali Mungeri, Abul Hasan Ali Nadwi (later).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• A madrasa syllabus mixing religious and modern subjects; unity among sects.
KEY EVENTS	• Reformed madrasa teaching; produced Arabic scholars.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Nadwat-ul-Ulama 1890s; Darul Uloom Nadwa, Lucknow.
RESULT	A middle path between Deoband and Aligarh.
LIMITS	• Small influence compared with Deoband and Aligarh.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Nadwa (middle path) vs Deoband (traditional) vs Aligarh (modern).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Nadwa = Lucknow; Shibli Nomani.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 4

1. Aligarh founder and year? (Syed Ahmad Khan, 1875)
2. Deoband founders and year? (Nanautavi and Gangohi, 1866)
3. Which school opposed the Congress at first? (Aligarh)
4. Where was Ahmadiyya based? (Qadian, 1889)
5. Which book defended Muslims after 1857? (*Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hind*)

8. Cluster 5: South India and caste movements

Veeresalingam and Telugu reform

1848–1919 23

WHEN	Journal 1874; first widow remarriage **11 Dec 1881**.
WHERE	Rajahmundry, Andhra.
WHY	Child marriage, enforced widowhood, devadasi custom and poor women's education.
BY WHOM	**Kandukuri Veeresalingam**.
KEY PEOPLE	Veeresalingam; Brahmo influence from Keshab's tour (Veda Samaj, Madras, 1864).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Widow remarriage, women's education, against devadasi custom (nautch) and child marriage; a rational, theistic outlook.
KEY EVENTS	• **1874** *Vivekavardhini* (Telugu journal). • **1881** First widow remarriage in the Telugu region. • Wrote the first Telugu novel, *Rajasekhara Charitramu* (1878); started a women's journal. • 1906 Hitakarini Samajam.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• *Vivekavardhini* 1874; *Rajasekhara Charitramu* 1878; Hitakarini Samajam 1906.
RESULT	Called the "Father of the Telugu renaissance".
LIMITS	• Faced social boycott; few followers.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Veeresalingam (Telugu, 1881) vs Vidyasagar (Bengal, 1856).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.

EXAM HOOK	Veeresalingam = Telugu widow remarriage 1881.

Veda Samaj

1864 19

WHEN	**1864**.
WHERE	Madras.
WHY	Inspired by Keshab Chandra Sen's 1864 visit: a Brahmo-type body for the south.
BY WHOM	K. Sridharalu Naidu.
KEY PEOPLE	Sridharalu Naidu; Keshab (inspiration).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Monotheism; against caste and idolatry; Brahmo-style.
KEY EVENTS	• Worship of one God; opposed caste and idol worship.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Veda Samaj 1864, Madras.
RESULT	Later called the Brahmo Samaj of South India.
LIMITS	• Small body.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Veda Samaj (Madras) is not the Arya Samaj (Vedic, Dayananda).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Veda Samaj = Madras 1864.

Narayana Guru and the SNDP Yogam

1856–1928 25

WHEN	Aruvippuram **1888**; SNDP **15 May 1903**; Advaita Ashram, Aluva, 1913.
WHERE	Travancore (Kerala): Aruvippuram, Sivagiri, Kollam.
WHY	The Ezhava community faced untouchability, entry bans to temples and Brahmin control of worship.
BY WHOM	**Narayana Guru** (an Ezhava). SNDP: **Dr P. Palpu** (driving force) and **Kumaran Asan** (secretary).
KEY PEOPLE	Narayana Guru; Dr Palpu; Kumaran Asan; T. K. Madhavan; Mahatma Gandhi (met him 1925).

IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• **One caste, one religion, one God for man.** • Advaita; temples open to all; education and cleanliness; against animal sacrifice and liquor.
KEY EVENTS	• **1888** He installed a Shiva idol at Aruvippuram: "not a Brahmin's Shiva but an Ezhava's Shiva". • **1903** SNDP Yogam formed (Narayana Guru as president). • **1913** Advaita Ashram at Aluva. • **1924** All Religions Conference at Aluva. • Slogan: "**One caste, one religion, one God for man**."
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Aruvippuram 1888; SNDP Yogam 1903; Advaita Ashram, Aluva 1913; *Atmopadesa Satakam*.
RESULT	Raised the status of Ezhavas; opened many temples and schools to all castes.
LIMITS	• Ezhava-centred; SNDP later became a caste organisation.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Narayana Guru (Ezhava) vs Ayyankali (Pulaya) vs Chattampi Swamikal vs Vaikunda Swamikal.
UPSC ASKED	• **2017 Mains:** Narayana Guru's intervention in social reform from a subaltern perspective.
EXAM HOOK	Narayana Guru = Ezhava. Ayyankali = Pulaya. Aruvippuram 1888.

Ayyankali and other Kerala reformers

1863–1941 25 26

WHEN	Villuvandi **1893**; Sadhu Jana Paripalana Sangham **1907**; NSS **1914**.
WHERE	Venganoor (Trivandrum); Perunna (Kottayam).
WHY	The Pulaya and other lower castes were barred from public roads, markets and schools.
BY WHOM	**Ayyankali** (Pulaya leader); Mannath Padmanabhan (NSS); Chattampi Swamikal.
KEY PEOPLE	Ayyankali; Mannath Padmanabhan; Chattampi Swamikal (1853–1924, scholar who opposed Brahmin dominance).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Right to roads, schools and public spaces for the lowest castes; labour strike as a tool.

KEY EVENTS	• **1893** Ayyankali rode a bullock cart (**Villuvandi**) down a public road, defying the ban. • **1907** Sadhu Jana Paripalana Sangham. • **1913** Agricultural strike to demand school admission for Pulaya children. • **1914** NSS (Nair Service Society) at Perunna.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Sadhu Jana Paripalana Sangham 1907; NSS 1914.
RESULT	Pulaya children got school admission; Ayyankali was nominated to the Sree Moolam Popular Assembly (1912).
LIMITS	• Pulaya struggle was long and faced violent opposition.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Ayyankali (Pulaya) is not Narayana Guru (Ezhava).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Ayyankali is not Narayana Guru.

Vaikom Satyagraha

1924–1925 26

WHEN	30 March 1924 to November 1925.
WHERE	Vaikom, Travancore.
WHY	The roads around the Vaikom Mahadeva temple were closed to the lower castes (avarnas).
BY WHOM	Kerala Congress leaders: **T. K. Madhavan, K. P. Kesava Menon, K. Kelappan**. Periyar joined.
KEY PEOPLE	T. K. Madhavan, K. P. Kesava Menon, George Joseph, Periyar (the "Vaikom Veerar"), Gandhi, Narayana Guru.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Non-violent protest against bans on roads near the temple; Gandhi gave moral support but did not lead.
KEY EVENTS	• **1924** Satyagraha begins. • **1925** Gandhi visited; roads opened (not temple entry). • **1931–32** Guruvayur Satyagraha. • **1936** Temple Entry Proclamation, Travancore (Chithira Thirunal).

INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Temple Entry Proclamation 1936.
RESULT	Roads opened in Nov 1925; led to the 1936 Proclamation.
LIMITS	• Won road access only; temple entry came in 1936.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Vaikom (1924–25, roads) vs Guruvayur (1931–32, temple entry).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Vaikom = temple roads. Guruvayur 1931. Proclamation 1936.

Vallalar (Ramalinga Adigal)

1823–1874 20

WHEN	Sangam **1865**; Dharma Salai **1867**; Gnana Sabha **1872**.
WHERE	Vadalur, near Cuddalore, Tamil Nadu.
WHY	Caste and sectarian quarrels and hunger. He taught love for all living beings.
BY WHOM	**Ramalinga Adigal (Vallalar)**.
KEY PEOPLE	Vallalar; devotees from all castes.
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• *Jeevakarunya* (compassion for all living beings); equality of all; worship of light.
KEY EVENTS	• **1865** Samarasa Suddha Sanmarga Sangam. • **1867** Satya Dharma Salai: free food for all (a kitchen that still runs). • **1872** Satya Gnana Sabha: worship of light, not idols. • *Thiruvarutpa* (his hymns).
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Sangam 1865; Dharma Salai 1867; Gnana Sabha 1872; *Thiruvarutpa*.
RESULT	A Tamil reformer who put **jeevakarunya** (compassion for all life) above ritual and caste.
LIMITS	• A spiritual movement with limited political impact.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Vallalar (Vadalur) is not Vaikunda Swamikal (Kanyakumari).

UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Vallalar = Vadalur.

Vaikunda Swamikal and Iyothee Thass

1809–1914 24 22 19

WHEN	Samathuva Samajam **1836**; Dravida Mahajana Sabha **1891**; Sakya Buddhist Society **1898**.
WHERE	Swamithoppu (Kanyakumari region); Nilgiris and Madras.
WHY	Caste oppression of lower castes, including the ban on the upper cloth for women (Channar revolt).
BY WHOM	**Vaikunda Swamikal** (1809–51); **Iyothee Thass** (1845–1914).
KEY PEOPLE	Vaikunda Swamikal; Iyothee Thass; Col. Olcott (helped Thass).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Vaikunda: equality and the Ayya Vazhi faith. Thass: Dalits as original Buddhists.
KEY EVENTS	• **1836** Samathuva Samajam: equality and the Ayya Vazhi faith. • **1859** Travancore allowed lower-caste women to wear the upper cloth. • **1891** Dravida Mahajana Sabha. • **1898** Sakya Buddhist Society, Madras. **1907** Weekly *Oru Paisa Tamilan*.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Samathuva Samajam 1836; Dravida Mahajana Sabha 1891; Sakya Buddhist Society 1898; *Oru Paisa Tamilan* 1907.
RESULT	Early Dalit assertion in the south; Thass argued Dalits were original Buddhists.
LIMITS	• Local following; limited political reach.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Iyothee Thass (Tamil Buddhist revival) vs Periyar (rationalist).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly.
EXAM HOOK	Thass = Tamil Buddhist revival; early Dalit leader.

Justice Party (South Indian Liberal Federation)

1916–1944 19

WHEN	Founded **20 Nov 1916**.
WHERE	Madras Presidency.
WHY	Brahmins held a large share of government jobs and college seats in Madras. The party wanted **non-Brahmin representation**.
BY WHOM	**T. M. Nair, P. Theagaraya Chetty, C. Natesa Mudaliar**.
KEY PEOPLE	T. M. Nair, Theagaraya Chetty, Natesa Mudaliar, A. Subbarayalu Reddiar (first Chief Minister 1920), Panagal Raja (Chief Minister 1921–26).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Non-Brahmin share in government jobs and the legislature; loyalty to British rule.
KEY EVENTS	• **Dec 1916** Non-Brahmin Manifesto. • Papers: *Justice*, *Dravidian*, *Andhra Prakasika*. • **1920** Won the first dyarchy elections and ran the Madras government. • **1921** Communal G.O.: reserved jobs for non-Brahmins.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Justice Party 1916; *Justice* (English), *Dravidian* (Tamil) and *Andhra Prakasika* (Telugu); Communal G.O. 1921.
RESULT	Lost power in 1937; Periyar took charge in 1938; renamed **Dravidar Kazhagam in 1944**.
LIMITS	• Elite non-Brahmins; lost the 1937 election; later absorbed by Periyar.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Justice Party (1916) vs Self-Respect Movement (1925).
UPSC ASKED	• Not asked directly as a stem.
EXAM HOOK	Justice Party 1916 ≠ Self-Respect 1925.

Self-Respect Movement (E. V. Ramasamy, Periyar)

1925–1944 21

WHEN	Launched **1925**; Chengalpattu conference **Feb 1929**; Dravidar Kazhagam **1944**.

WHERE	Erode (*Kudi Arasu*), Tamil Nadu.
WHY	Brahmin dominance in religion and politics, caste, superstition, and women's subordination.
BY WHOM	**E. V. Ramasamy (Periyar)**, after leaving the Congress in 1925.
KEY PEOPLE	Periyar; S. Ramanathan; Annadurai (joined later).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Rationalism; dignity for the oppressed; abolition of caste and priest-led ritual; women's equality and widow remarriage.
KEY EVENTS	• **1924** Vaikom Satyagraha (Periyar joined). • **1925** Left the Congress; started the movement and the weekly *Kudi Arasu* at Erode. • **1929** First Self-Respect Conference, Chengalpattu: resolutions against caste titles. • **Self-respect marriages** without priests; legalised in Madras in 1967. • **1938** Anti-Hindi agitation. **1944** Salem: Justice Party became DK.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• *Kudi Arasu* 1925; Chengalpattu conference 1929; self-respect marriages; DK 1944.
RESULT	Rationalist, anti-caste and pro-women politics became the base of Dravidian politics. UPSC asked about it in 2019 and 2025.
LIMITS	• Strongly anti-religion; narrow outside Tamil Nadu.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Periyar's Self-Respect Movement (1925) vs the Justice Party leaders (1916) vs Iyothee Thass.
UPSC ASKED	• **2025:** Founder of the Self-Respect Movement = Periyar E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker. • **2021:** The Self-Respect Movement was initiated by E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker. • **2019:** Self-Respect Movement–E. V. Ramaswami Naicker, a correct pair.
EXAM HOOK	Self-Respect = Periyar, 1925. Not founded by Justice Party leaders.

Dr Ambedkar's early movement (bonus)

1924–1932 6

WHEN	Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha **1924**; Mahad **1927**.
WHERE	Bombay; Mahad (Raigad); Nashik.
WHY	Untouchables were barred from public tanks and temples.
BY WHOM	**B. R. Ambedkar**.
KEY PEOPLE	Ambedkar; Shahu Maharaj (helper).
IDEAS AND TEACHINGS	• Social democracy; the right to public water and temples; political rights for the depressed classes.
KEY EVENTS	• **1920** *Mooknayak*; **1927** *Bahishkrit Bharat*. • **March 1927** Mahad Satyagraha for the Chavdar tank. • **Dec 1927** Burning of the *Manusmriti*. • **1930** Kalaram temple entry, Nashik. • **1932** Poona Pact.
INSTITUTIONS AND PUBLICATIONS	• Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha 1924; *Mooknayak* 1920; *Bahishkrit Bharat* 1927; Independent Labour Party and Scheduled Castes Federation (later).
RESULT	Beyond the Day 6 reform era; it belongs with the Gandhian period.
LIMITS	• Beyond the Day 6 reform era.
DO NOT CONFUSE	• Mahad (tank, 1927) vs Kalaram (temple, 1930).
UPSC ASKED	• **2012:** Ambedkar founded the Independent Labour Party and the All India Scheduled Castes Federation (answer: 2 and 3).
EXAM HOOK	Mahad = Ambedkar, 1927, tank, not temple.

QUICK RECALL: CLUSTER 5

1. Narayana Guru's caste and his slogan? (Ezhava; one caste, one religion, one God)
2. Who led the Pulaya struggle? (Ayyankali)
3. Who started the Self-Respect Movement and when? (Periyar, 1925)
4. Who founded the Justice Party? (Nair, Theagaraya Chetty, Natesa Mudaliar, 1916)
5. Which first widow remarriage happened in 1881 in Telugu land? (Veeresalingam)

9. Cluster 6: Social legislation

Year	Law	Who pushed it	Why and what it did
1795, 1804	Bengal Regulations	Company	Declared infanticide murder.
1829	**Regulation XVII** (Bentinck)	**Roy**	Abolished **sati**; first applied in Bengal, extended to Bombay and Madras in 1830.
1843	Indian Slavery Act (Ellenborough)	Company	Ended the legal status of slavery.
1850	Caste Disabilities Removal Act (Dalhousie)	Company	A convert keeps inheritance rights; later one cause of resentment in 1857.
1856	**Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act**	**Vidyasagar**	Made widow remarriage legal.
1865	Parsi Marriage and Divorce Act	Parsi reformers	Registered Parsi marriage; allowed divorce.
1870	**Female Infanticide Prevention Act**	Government	Birth registration in the infanticide-prone areas.
1872	**Native (Special) Marriage Act**	**Keshab**	Civil marriage; girls **14**, boys **18**; banned polygamy; allowed intercaste marriage.

Year	Law	Who pushed it	Why and what it did
1891	**Age of Consent Act**	**Malabari**, Ranade	Raised age of consent from **10 to 12** after the Phulmoni Dasi death (1889).
1909	Anand Marriage Act	Singh Sabha	Legal recognition for Sikh marriage rites.
1929	**Sarda Act**	Harbilas Sarda	Child Marriage Restraint Act: girls **14**, boys **18**.

ORDER

Sati (1829) → Slavery (1843) → Caste Disabilities (1850) → Widow Remarriage (1856) → Infanticide (1870) → Native Marriage (1872) → Age of Consent (1891) → Sarda (1929).

UPSC HAS ASKED

- 2016: **Satya Shodhak Samaj** was an anti-caste movement in Maharashtra.
- 2016: Keshab set up the **Indian Reform Association** and the Tabernacle of New Dispensation.
- 2019 and 2025: **Self-Respect Movement** = E. V. Ramasamy.
- 2020: *Vital-Vidhvansak* = Gopal Baba Walangkar; Rakhmabai case 1884 = age of consent and restitution of conjugal rights.
- 2021: Vidyasagar was Secretary of the Hindu Female School (Bethune).
- 2025: Roy loved Eastern philosophy and wanted rationalism and dignity.

10. Master timeline (all movements in one strip)

Year	What
1809	Roy: *Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin*
1815	Atmiya Sabha

Year	What
1817	Hindu College
1828	Brahmo Sabha; Derozio's Academic Association
1829	Sati banned
1830	Dharma Sabha
1836	Vaikunda Swamikal: Samathuva Samajam
1839	Tattvabodhini Sabha
1844	Manav Dharma Sabha
1848	Phule's girls' school; Students' Literary and Scientific Society
1849	Paramahansa Mandali; Bethune School
1851	Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha
1856	Widow Remarriage Act
1861	Radha Soami
1863	Muhammadan Literary Society
1864	Veda Samaj; Aligarh Scientific Society
1865	Vallalar's Sangam
1866	Deoband; Brahmo Samaj of India
1867	Prarthana Samaj
1870	Indian Reform Association; Poona Sarvajanik Sabha
1872	Native Marriage Act
1873	Singh Sabha; Satyashodhak Samaj; *Gulamgiri*
1875	Arya Samaj; Theosophical Society; MAO College
1878	Sadharan Brahmo Samaj
1881	Veeresalingam's widow remarriage
1882	Arya Mahila Samaj; Adyar HQ
1884	Deccan Education Society
1885	Seva Sadan
1886	DAV School

Year	What
1887	National Social Conference; Deva Samaj
1888	Aruvippuram; *Vital-Vidhvansak*
1889	Ahmadiyya; Sharada Sadan
1891	Age of Consent Act; Dravida Mahajana Sabha
1892	Khalsa College
1893	Chicago; Arya Samaj split
1894	Nadwat-ul-Ulama
1897	Ramakrishna Mission
1898	Central Hindu College; Sakya Buddhist Society
1902	Gurukul Kangri; Shahu's reservation
1903	SNDP
1905	Servants of India Society
1907	Ayyankali's Sangham
1914	NSS
1916	Justice Party; SNDT; Home Rule League
1920	AMU; Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind (1919)
1924	Vaikom Satyagraha
1925	Self-Respect Movement
1927	Mahad
1929	Sarda Act
1936	Temple Entry Proclamation, Travancore

MEMORY HOOKS

- **Brahmo chain:** Roy 28 → Debendranath 39 → Keshab 66 → Sadharan 78 (just remember the last two digits: 28, 39, 66, 78).
- **The 1870s run:** Prarthana 67, Singh Sabha 73, Satyashodhak 73, Arya Samaj 75, Theosophy 75, Aligarh 75. Three things happened in 1875.
- **Founded in Bombay:** Prarthana (1867) and Arya Samaj (1875). **Founded in Pune:** Satyashodhak (1873).

11. Mixed revision (from earlier days)

Acts, in order

Act	Key points
Regulating Act 1773	Governor of Bengal became Governor-General (Hastings); council of four; **Supreme Court at Calcutta** (Impey, opened 1774); ban on private trade.
Act of Settlement 1781	Clarified the Supreme Court's jurisdiction: **exempted acts of the Governor-General-in-Council and revenue matters**; respected Hindu and Muslim personal laws.
Pitt's India Act 1784	**Board of Control** for political affairs; Court of Directors for commerce and patronage (dual control); council cut to **three**.
Charter Act 1793	Charter renewed for 20 years.
Charter Act 1813	Monopoly of Indian trade ended **except tea and China trade**; Crown's sovereignty asserted; missionaries allowed; **₹1 lakh a year** for education.
Charter Act 1833	Company's **tea and China monopoly ended; it stopped trading**. **Law Member** added (Macaulay); Law Commission; Governor-General of India (Bentinck); no Indian to be barred from office by religion or birth.
Charter Act 1853	**Open competition** for the civil service; **separate legislative wing** of the council; charter **not** fixed for a term.

Act	Key points
GoI Act 1858	Crown rule; Secretary of State; Viceroy.

Governor-Generals in order

Hastings (1772–85) · Cornwallis (1786–93) · Shore (1793–98) · Wellesley (1798–1805) · Cornwallis again (1805) · Barlow (1805–07) · **Minto I (1807–13)** · Hastings, Moira (1813–23) · Adam (1823) · **Amherst (1823–28)** · Bentinck (1828–35) · Metcalfe (1835–36) · Auckland (1836–42) · **Ellenborough (1842–44)** · **Hardinge I (1844–48)** · Dalhousie (1848–56) · Canning (1856–62).

Wellesley, Bentinck, Ellenborough

Who	Facts
Wellesley	Tanjore taken 1799; Surat 1800; **Carnatic 1801**. **Awadh ceded about half its territory** (Rohilkhand and the Lower Doab) in 1801 under the Subsidiary Alliance; it was **not** annexed whole. Fort William College 1800.
Bentinck	Abolished sati (1829); Thagi suppressed; deputy collectors and magistrates opened to Indians; Provincial Courts of Appeal and Circuit abolished; English education (1835); Medical College 1835. **Did not annex Sindh.**
Ellenborough	**Sindh annexed 1843** after Napier's victory at Miani.

Dalhousie's annexations, in order

Year	State	How
1848	Satara	Lapse
1849	Punjab	Second Anglo-Sikh War
1849–50	Jaitpur, Sambalpur, Baghat	Lapse
1852	Lower Burma (Pegu); Udaipur	War; lapse
1853	**Jhansi**; Berar (taken for debt)	Lapse; debt
1854	Nagpur	Lapse
1856	**Awadh**	Misrule

Dalhousie's other work: the first railway (Bombay to Thane, 1853), the telegraph (built by **William O'Shaughnessy**; Cautley and Cotton were irrigation engineers), the Post Office Act 1854, the Public Works Department, Wood's Despatch 1854.

Administration facts asked again today

Topic	Fact
Indian Civil Service	**Satyendranath Tagore**, first Indian ICS, **1863**. Age limit cut to **19** (1876, under Lytton). The exam was held **only in London** until the 1920s.
Law codes	**First Law Commission** under Macaulay: set up under the **Charter Act of 1833**. Indian Penal Code **1860**; Code of Criminal Procedure **1861**.
Police	**Police Act 1861** modelled on the **Irish Constabulary**.
Cornwallis Code 1793	Company servants answerable to civil courts for official acts; rule of law; but Indians kept out of senior posts.
Inam Commission 1852	Bombay; **resumed many rent-free holdings**. A grievance before 1857.

Compare and contrast tables

Brahmo, Prarthana, Arya and Satyashodhak

Point	Brahmo Samaj	Prarthana Samaj	Arya Samaj	Satyashodhak
Founder, year	Roy, 1828	Atmaram Pandurang, 1867	Dayananda, 1875	Phule, 1873
Place	Calcutta	Bombay	Bombay (later Lahore)	Pune
Authority	Reason and Upanishads	Saints and reason	Vedas infallible	Equality; against priests

Point	Brahmo Samaj	Prarthana Samaj	Arya Samaj	Satyashodhak
Idols and caste	Rejected idols; opposed caste	Opposed caste	Rejected idols; caste by birth	Attacked Brahmin priesthood
Special feature	Anti-sati; modern education	Social service; Ranade	Shuddhi; DAV schools	Gulamgiri; girls' schools

Aligarh and Deoband

Point	Aligarh	Deoband
Founder, year	Syed Ahmad Khan, 1875	Mohammad Qasim Nanotvi, 1866
Approach	Modern education, Urdu and English	Pure Islam, Quran and hadith
Politics	Loyal to the British; kept away from the Congress	Later joined nationalists (Jamiat 1919)
Funding	Government and elite	Public donations only

Kerala and Tamil caste movements

Leader	Community	Key act	Year
Narayana Guru	Ezhava	Aruvippuram Shiva; SNDP	1888; 1903
Ayyankali	Pulaya	Villuvandi; Sadhu Jana Paripalana Sangham	1893; 1907
Vaikunda Swamikal	Nadar and others	Samathuva Samajam	1836
Periyar	Non-Brahmin	Self-Respect Movement	1925
Justice Party	Non-Brahmin elite	South Indian Liberal Federation	1916

Reformist and revivalist

Type	Examples	Method
Reformist	Brahmo, Prarthana, Aligarh, Young Bengal	Reason and Western learning
Revivalist	Arya Samaj, Deoband, Ramakrishna Mission (partly)	Return to old texts and pride in the past

Previous-year questions on this topic (as traced)

Year	Question and answer
2025	Periyar E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker: founder of the Self-Respect Movement.
2025	Roy: Eastern philosophy plus rational, scientific thinking and social equality. Both statements correct.
2021	Self-Respect Movement initiated by E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker.
2021	Vidyasagar was the Secretary of the Hindu Female School (later Bethune School).
2020	Rakhmabai case 1884: age of consent and conjugal rights. *Vital-Vidhvansak*: Gopal Baba Walangkar.
2019	Self-Respect Movement matched with E. V. Ramaswami Naicker.
2018	Order of events: Neel Darpan, first Indian in ICS (1863), Arya Samaj (1875), Anandamath (1882).
2016	Satya Shodhak Samaj: anti-caste movement in Maharashtra.
2015	Keshab: Indian Reform Association and Tabernacle of New Dispensation.
2014	National Social Conference formed as a separate body for social reform.
2012	Brahmo Samaj opposed idolatry and priestly class; Ambedkar founded the Independent Labour Party.

Years come from published paper compilations; where sources differed I used the one that matched the official key. Some older items (2001, 2005, 2012, 2014, Mains) are from coaching compilations and are less certain: treat their years as approximate.

12. Last-minute sheet

Book and author

Book	Author
Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin; Precepts of Jesus	Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Satyarth Prakash	Dayananda Saraswati
Gulamgiri	Jyotirao Phule
The High Caste Hindu Woman	Pandita Ramabai
Asbab-i-Baghawat-i-Hind	Syed Ahmad Khan
Neel Darpan	Dinabandhu Mitra
Anandamath	Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
Vital-Vidhvansak	Gopal Baba Walangkar
Notes on Infant Marriage and Enforced Widowhood	B. M. Malabari

Institution and founder

Institution	Founder or leader
Hindu College (1817)	David Hare and Hindu elites
Bethune School (1849)	J. E. D. Bethune; Vidyasagar (Secretary)
DAV School, Lahore (1886)	Lala Hansraj
Gurukul Kangri (1902)	Swami Shraddhanand
MAO College, Aligarh (1875)	Syed Ahmad Khan
Ramakrishna Mission (1897)	Vivekananda
Central Hindu College (1898)	Annie Besant
Deccan Education Society (1884)	Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar
Sharada Sadan; Arya Mahila Samaj	Pandita Ramabai
Seva Sadan (1885)	Malabari and Gidumal
Khalsa College (1892)	Singh Sabha leaders

Institution	Founder or leader
SNDP Yogam (1903)	Narayana Guru, Dr Palpu, Kumaran Asan
SNDT University (1916)	D. K. Karve

WRONG STATEMENTS UPSC LIKES

- Roy founded the Hindu College. (No.)
- Debendranath founded the Brahmo Samaj. (No: Roy, 1828.)
- Keshab founded the Sadharan Brahmo Samaj. (No: his critics, 1878.)
- Prarthana Samaj founded by Phule. (No: Atmaram Pandurang.)
- Arya Samaj founded at Lahore. (No: Bombay.)
- Phule founded his Samaj at Nagpur. (No: Pune.)
- Narayana Guru was a Pulaya. (No: Ezhava.)
- Besant founded the Theosophical Society. (No.)
- Syed Ahmad urged Muslims to join the Congress. (No.)
- Deoband endorsed Aligarh's loyalty. (No.)
- Age of Consent raised to 14; Sarda fixed 16 for girls. (No: 12; 14.)
- Telegraph by Cautley. (No: O'Shaughnessy.)
- First Law Commission under the 1853 Act. (No: 1833.)

Sources: Spectrum, *A Brief History of Modern India* (Socio-Religious Reform Movements; Administrative Organisation; Expansion and Consolidation); M. Laxmikanth, *Indian Polity*, Ch. 1; Bipan Chandra, *India's Struggle for Independence*; Rau's IAS, GKToday, PW OnlyIAS and Vajiram and Ravi notes; UPSC Prelims 2016–2025 papers. Written in my own words for study. Map outline: Datameet composite India boundary, simplified; pins are approximate. Dates for minor bodies vary slightly between books: use the book's version if a question asks for a specific year.